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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

SPECTACULAR OPENING TO GLOBAL VILLAGE

Global Village opened its gates to the world with a spectacular ceremony, replete with a dazzling parade, wing-suited skydivers, drone shows, and fireworks. At 6pm yesterday, the 30th season burst into life with confetti, breathtaking pyrotechnics, and a grand parade featuring drummers, breakdancers, vibrant Latin performances, and a stunning Levant show, thrilling thousands of visitors who had converged on the opening day. **SEE ALSO P5**

5 new multi-storey car parks in Dubai

Parkin's facilities to be fully-automated for faster, cashless, fully connected experience

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Parkin plans to construct five new multi-storey car parks across Dubai within the next two years, featuring fully automated systems, EV charging points and integrated payment technology, its chief executive said on the sidelines of Gitex Global 2025.

Mohammad Abdulla Al Ali, CEO of Parkin, said the new facilities will be strategically

located in high-traffic business districts to meet rising demand for structured parking and improve turnover. "The aim is to make the parking experience completely seamless," he said. "We want people to be able to park, pay and leave without barriers, paper tickets or manual interference."

Cashless, open-flow model

By the end of this year, Parkin expects all off-street and multi-storey parking in Dubai to operate under a fully cashless, open-flow model. Customers will be able to make automatic payments through linked wallets or the Parkin app, which now supports individual, family and business accounts for large vehicle fleets. **SEE ALSO P7**

Al Ali said the company is investing heavily in technology such as AI-based inspection systems and unified digital platforms that connect with the Roads and Transport Authority (RTA).

"Our systems are integrated 24/7. Nearly 93 per cent of customer calls are now resolved immediately without escalation," he added.

The CEO said the company's dynamic pricing model, introduced in April, has already helped reduce congestion.

Parkin is also expanding partnerships with private developers and government entities to standardise the parking experience across malls, mosques and mixed-use communities.

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Gaza aid flows stumble amid Rafah delay

GAZA 'NEEDS 1,000 TRUCKS DAILY, AND ALL SIX CROSSINGS MUST OPEN'

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

Aid was set to flow into Gaza yesterday as Israel prepared to open the Rafah border crossing with Egypt, allowing hundreds of trucks carrying humanitarian supplies to enter the war-ravaged enclave under a US-brokered ceasefire.

About 600 trucks of humanitarian aid were scheduled to cross into Gaza, carrying food, fuel, and medical supplies, according to reports.

On Sunday, around 800 trucks entered through the Kerem Shalom and Kissufim crossings on Israel's border with Gaza — up from the previous daily rate of 300, but still below the level required, Amjad Shawa, director of the Palestinian NGOs Network, told Bloomberg News.

More aid trucks needed

"Gaza needs 1,000 trucks daily, and all six border crossings must open to meet escalating humanitarian needs," he said.

The shipments are being co-ordinated by the United Nations, approved international organisations, private donors, and regional partners.

The decision to open Rafah was reportedly approved by Israel's "political echelon" after Hamas handed over the remains of four more Israeli hostages late

The Israeli military said one of the bodies handed over Tuesday was not that of a hostage, prompting criticism from lawmakers and renewed calls to link humanitarian aid to the return of the remaining bodies.

Tuesday as part of the truce arrangement.

The Israeli military said one of the bodies handed over Tuesday was not that of a hostage, prompting criticism from lawmakers and renewed calls to link humanitarian aid to the return of the remaining bodies.

Israel's far-right National Security Minister Itamar Ben Gvir earlier threatened to block aid shipments unless Hamas released all captives and returned the remains of Israeli soldiers still held in Gaza.

At the White House, US President Donald Trump said Hamas had informed his envoys that it would disarm, warning that if it failed to do so, "it could be dealt with violently." He later clarified that the message was conveyed through his "people," referring to US special envoy Steve Witkoff and adviser Jared Kushner. **SEE ALSO P9**

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